of the UN.

Evaluation

Though limited in membership and with sweeping powers to permanent members, the Security Council is the most powerful of all organs of the United Nations. It is the only organ which has the authority to make decisions that are binding and take collective actions to restore international peace and security. However, the *veto* power is the most paralyzing of all the provisions and has led to a number of deadlocks over the years especially during the Cold War years. One such deadlock over the Korean issue arising from the superpower rivalry had prompted the General Assembly to adopt the Uniting for Peace Resolution (UPR) in order to take action whenever the Security Council stands paralyzed. Acting under UPR (1950), the General Assembly usurped the power of Security Council and took action in Korea (1950–1953) and Congo (1960–1964), and virtually bypassed the Security Council.

However, from the late 60s, when the Security Council again resumed its powers and functions, it aptly handled the crises in CONGO (ONUC), the Cuban Missile Crisis (1962), the Cyprus Question (1964), the Rhodesian Embargo Issue (1968), the Arab–Israeli War (1967 and 1973), the Indo–Pak War (1971), the South Africa and Cambodia issues and the later operations. However, post-Cold War and the disintegration of the Soviet Union have left the Security Council as a mere pawn in the hands of the United States which is today the only superpower. For example, the Gulf Crises of 1991 and 2003 show outright assertion of the sole superpower in the world. The action to be undertaken by the Security Council now rests more on the consideration of the Big-Five, especially the US, and much depends on the power relationship of the permanent-5 and their relationship with the non-permanent members. Therefore, the Security Council has failed to deliver its best. Demand is there for an expansion and democratization of the organ and some emerging powers like India, Brazil, Germany and Japan, along with some other claimants desire to become permanent members of the Security Council.[12] Nevertheless, the importance of Security Council in the maintenance of international peace and security cannot be